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TAB 16



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-007-24/25, Version: 2

Mr. Schmerelson - Fostering Healthy Relationships through Digital Citizenship Week (Res-007-24/25)
(Noticed September 10, 2024)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has established policies and systems ~~the Instructional Technology Initiative (ITI) with its mission~~ to focus on providing professional opportunities on instructional frameworks that leverage technology in purposeful and personalized ways;

Whereas, The ~~ITI~~ District departments coordinates with one another on instructional technology initiatives ~~and collaborates with various district departments~~ as well as with external partners to serve the needs of District students;

Whereas, The ~~ITI~~ District has established mandatory digital citizenship classes for students, exploring topics such as artificial intelligence, responsible digital use, and social media lessons to help build a responsible digital culture in the classroom and beyond;

Whereas, The District distributes professional development opportunities for teachers over the summer that focus on best practices to incorporate technology as a tool to better instruct and manage classroom settings;

Whereas, The LAUSD community is constantly surrounded by technological advancements, whether they are in the classroom, at home, in public spaces, or taking public transit, among other areas;

Whereas, The District is expanding opportunities for eSports programs that incorporate STEAM curriculum, allowing students an accessible pathway into the arts and sciences;

Whereas, The District has established the 2024 Digital Citizenship Challenge, incorporating leaderboards and prizes for the schools that meet or exceed digital citizenship standards;

Whereas, Digital Citizenship fits into LAUSD's strategic plan, focusing on pillars 1A (high-quality instruction), 1C (eliminating opportunity gaps), 2B (whole-child well-being), and 2C (strong social-emotional skills);

Whereas, The District recognizes the importance of inclusivity in digital spaces, ensuring that all students, regardless of socio-economic status, race, ethnicity, gender, or ability, have equitable access to technology and resources necessary for developing digital literacy and citizenship skills;

Whereas, Digital citizenship extends beyond the classroom, requiring students to understand the importance of balanced technology use, managing screen time, and the potential mental and physical health impacts of excessive digital consumption;

Whereas, The District is committed to fostering informed digital participation by teaching students to critically analyze digital content, engage with diverse perspectives online, and contribute to civic and social issues through responsible digital platforms;

Whereas, The District acknowledges the increasing importance of privacy and security in the age of AI, encouraging students to protect personal information online and be alert to online scams, data breaches, and privacy violations;

Whereas, The rise of artificial intelligence and machine learning necessitates teaching students how these technologies influence the information they consume, emphasizing the importance of understanding AI's role in shaping their digital experiences, biases, and decision-making;

Whereas, Digital citizenship education fosters collaboration and problem-solving skills in online spaces, preparing students for a future where teamwork and digital communication are essential in both academic and professional settings;

Whereas, The District is committed to supporting parents and guardians in their roles as digital mentors for their children, offering resources and training on topics such as online safety, cyberbullying prevention, and managing digital footprints;

Whereas, The District aims to promote digital resilience among students, equipping them with the skills to navigate challenges such as misinformation, cyberbullying, and online harassment with confidence, critical thinking, and proactive strategies for positive digital engagement;

Whereas, Academic settings maintain a responsibility to their students to foster a safe environment, teaching students about subjects such as civic engagement and being responsible citizens while addressing the effects ~~negative impacts~~ of cyberbullying and the difference between ~~truths~~, half-truths, lies, facts, and opinions;

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District passed the Critical Media Literacy resolution on March 9, 2021, specifically addressing the misinformation campaigns in social media, radio, television, and in publications on Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter/X, among other social media platforms, and what the District can do to teach students about online misinformation;

Whereas, The rise growth of artificial intelligence ~~has posed a danger to student learning, taking content from the internet and reflecting information to users as factual even when it is to the contrary;~~ presents an opportunity to enhance student learning, it is essential to guide students in critically evaluating AI-generated content, helping them discern between accurate information and misinformation; and

Whereas, Studies also show that ~~widespread damage~~ addressing the spread of misinformation has a direct cause of violence, rejection of modern medicine/science, and increase in depression and suicide among student populations and their families and others; can significantly reduce violence, encourage acceptance of modern medicine and science, and promote mental well-being, leading to lower rates of depression and suicide among students, their families and communities; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District will acknowledge the week of Monday, October 16 to Sunday, October 22, 2024, as Digital Citizenship Week;

Resolved further, That all students will complete the Digital Citizenship course to demonstrate ability to discern online scams, AI manipulation and forms of digital misinformation and cyberbullying;

Resolved further, That the Board recommends that the Superintendent or a designee oversee opportunities for parents and guardians to actively participate in Digital Citizenship Week through the parent center, email updates, and other suitable platforms. These efforts will empower them with knowledge about AI-generated content in pictures and videos and best practices in navigating such situations; ~~appropriate mediums to teach them about online scams, AI manipulation in pictures and videos, and best practices for such instances;~~ and, be it finally

Resolved, That District staff will update the Board regarding ~~this matter~~ digital citizenship no later than May 2025 through a presentation during that month's Committee of the Whole or through an informative.